took India to the World Court in the Hague over this project.[31] Pakistan was rattled that India was now exploiting its legal right to tap into the water of the Jhelum and it decided to prepare a similar project on the Pakistani side of the river. This gave rise to the Neelum hydropower project. Reading between the lines, the Pakistanis consulted with the Chinese and, as a result, awarded the contract to a Chinese company in 2008. While India claimed that the Kishenganga Dam was only going to tap into 10 per cent of the river's waters, Pakistan claimed that it would affect 33 per cent of the flow of the river. The Neelum hydropower project, in fact, is in many ways a mirrored replica of the Kishenganga hydropower project. Both these projects tap into the waters of the same river on opposite sides of the LoC and then drain the waters back into the Jhelum River.

The year 2008 saw pro-*azaadi* or freedom demonstrations erupt in the valley. On 26 May 2008, the Government of India and the state government reached an agreement to transfer 99 acres of forest land to the Shri Amarnath Shrine Board in the valley to set up temporary shelters and facilities for Hindu pilgrims. This caused a controversy, with demonstrations from the Kashmir Valley against the land transfer. The largest demonstration saw more than 500,000 protestors at a single rally, among the largest in Kashmir's history. Six people were killed and 100 injured when police fired into a crowd of protestors in Srinagar. The separatist JKLF (R) organised a march to the site of the controversial land in Baltal. Senior separatist leaders Shabir Ahmed Shah, Syed Ali Shah Geelani and Mirwaiz Umar Farooq, leaders of the Hurriyat, which planned the protests, were placed under house arrest. Throughout the Srinagar area, most public buildings and many businesses remained closed. This was no coincidence. These protests caused the Kishenganga project to be substantially delayed as work slowed down and completion milestones began to get delayed. Were these protests engineered by the ISI after almost five years of peace in the valley so as to delay commencement of work on the project?

On 11 June 2010, violent protests erupted in Srinagar on account of a case of a fake encounter by the Indian Army, killing three locals in the